The Certainty of Uncertainty

How did we get here? Where do we go?

KANDINSKY

Berlin - October 2026

Andrea Magnorsky

About Andrea

Software Architect, Programmer*
and Creator of Bytesize
Architecture Sessions

---

roundcrisis.com

/in/magnorsky

@types.pl@roundcrisis

@roundcrisis.com

MODEL BRIDGE
SOFTWARE & SYSTEMS

Consulting | Fractional Architecture | Trainning

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

*Programmer vs Developer https://einarwh.no/blog/2021/02/11/programmer-vs-developer/

Tui - Native bird of New Zealand

Agenda

- The day after the day before. A tale of layoffs
- Is the grass always greener in greenfield?
- The mess we are in

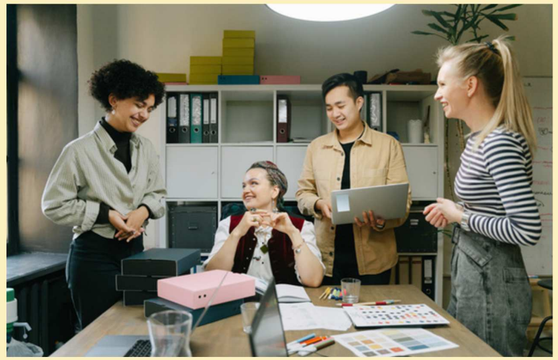
Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

The day after the day before.

A tale of layoffs

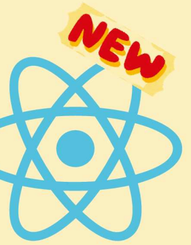
Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Context



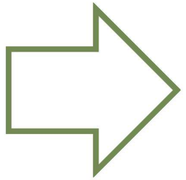
Cool!
Scala
Programming Language

NEW



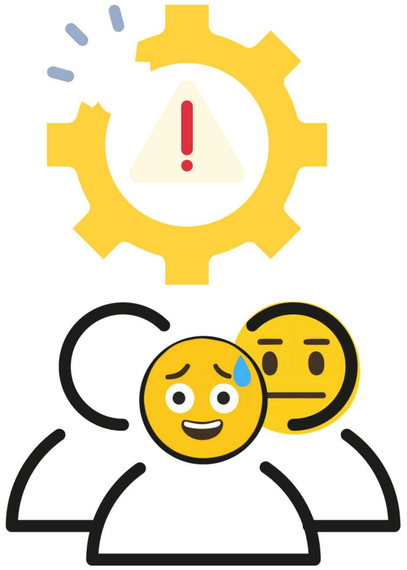
Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

The problem

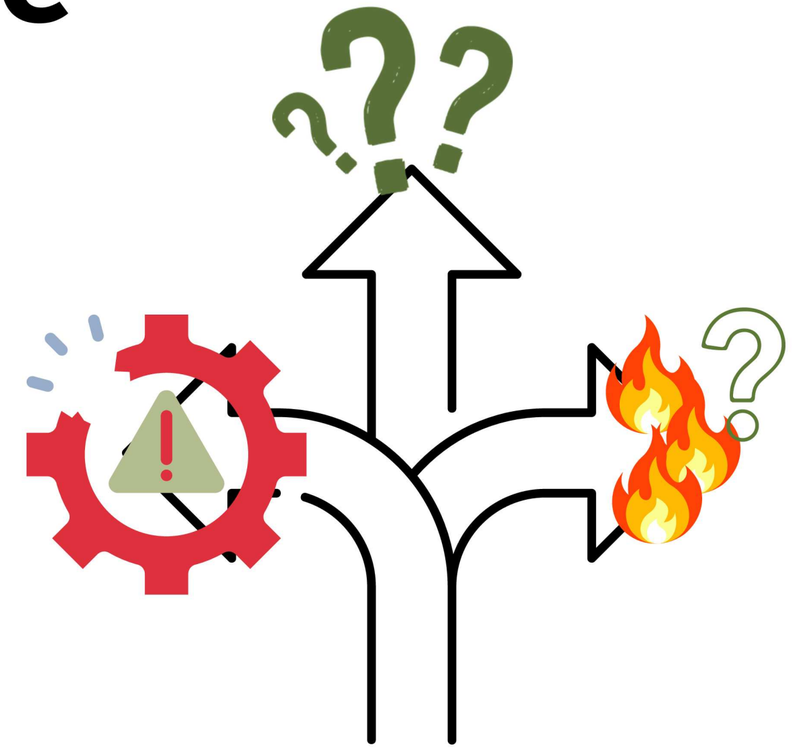


Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Focus and area of influence



Disrupted teams



Roadmap unclear

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Recover, Do

Recovery is the correct action

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Build Community

Improve learning and safety

Sense of community is a feeling that members have of **belonging**, a feeling that members **matter to one another** and to the group, and a shared faith that members' **needs will be met** through their commitment to be together

Sense of Community: A Definition and Theory
David W. McMillan and David M. Chavis

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Build Community

Improve growth, learning and safety

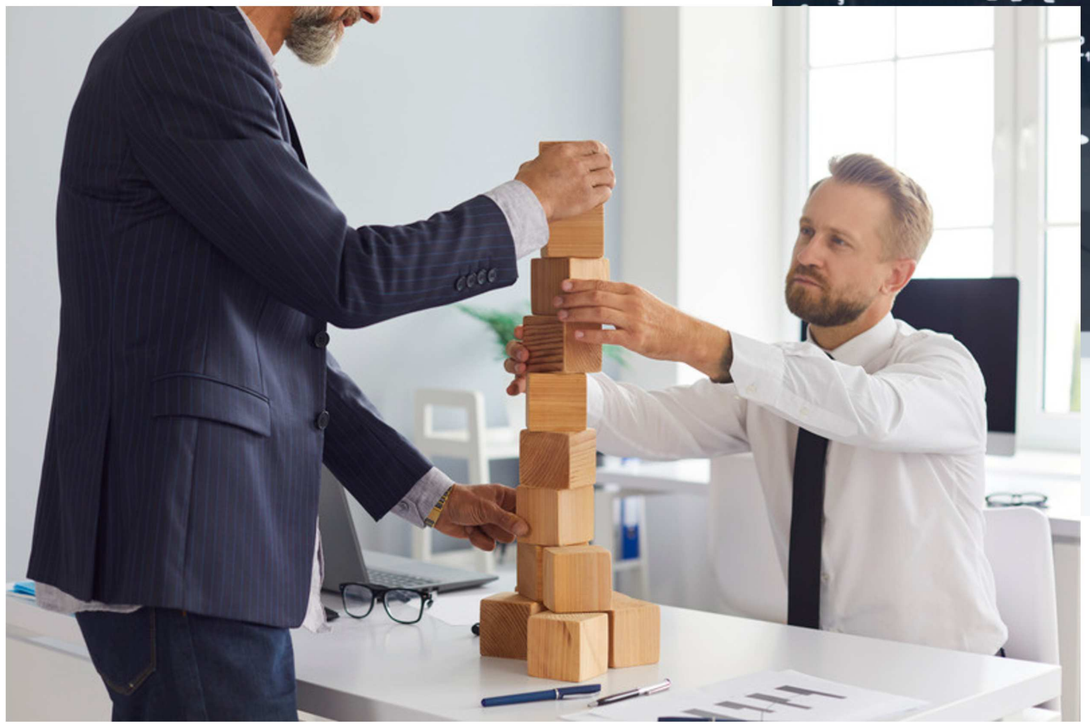
"...common ground refers to a process of communicating, testing, updating, tailoring, and repairing mutual understanding."

Common Ground and Coordination in Joint Activity
Gary Klein, Paul J. Feltovich, Jeffrey M. Bradshaw, David D. Woods

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Understand

Nuance, validation, feedback loops



Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Build Community

Improve learning
and safety

Understand

Nuance, validate,
feedback loops

Act

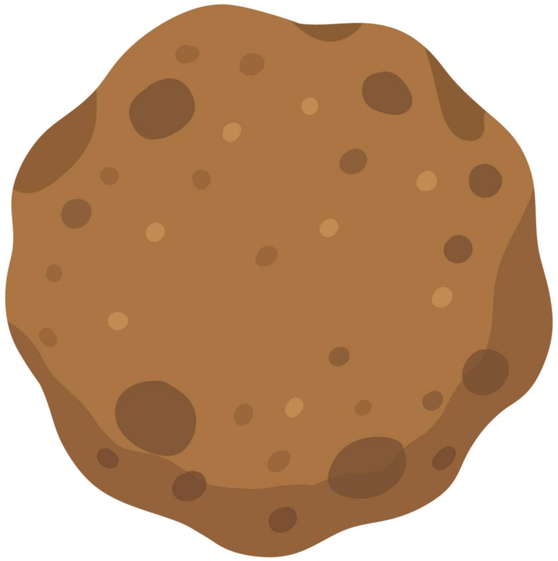
Recover, Do

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

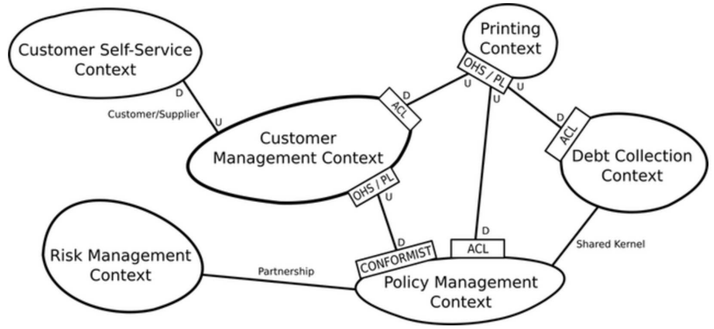
The grass is always greener in... greenfield?

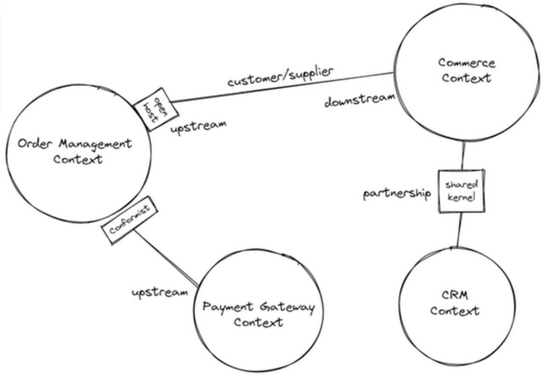
Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Context



Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

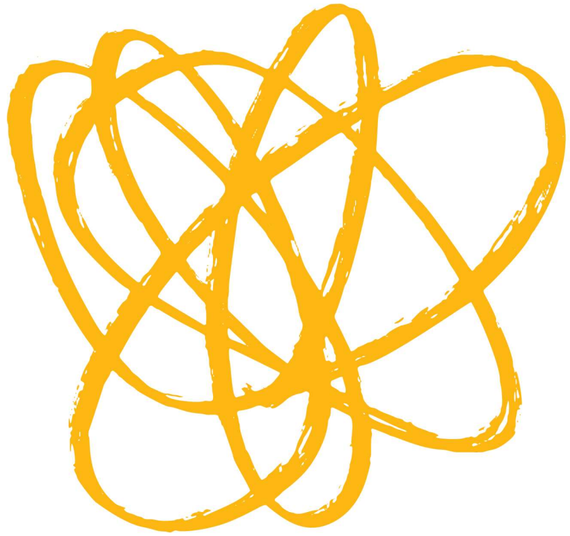




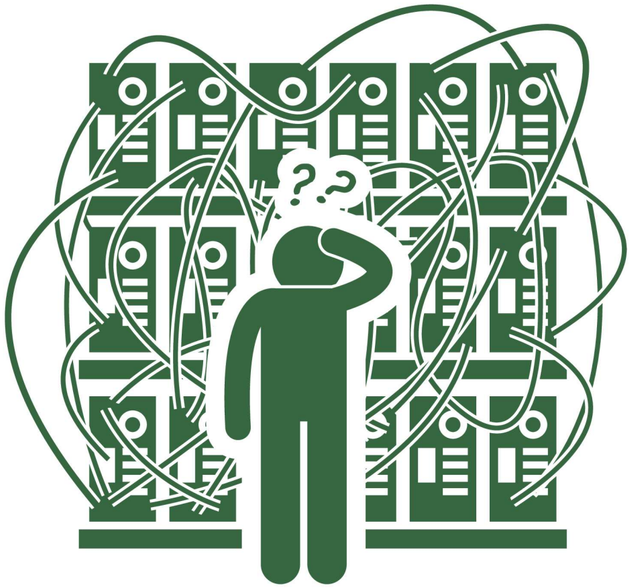
Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Understand

Nuance, validation, feedback loops



Decision making



Knowledge gap

Strategic gap

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Addressing Decision making uncertainty

Decision process review

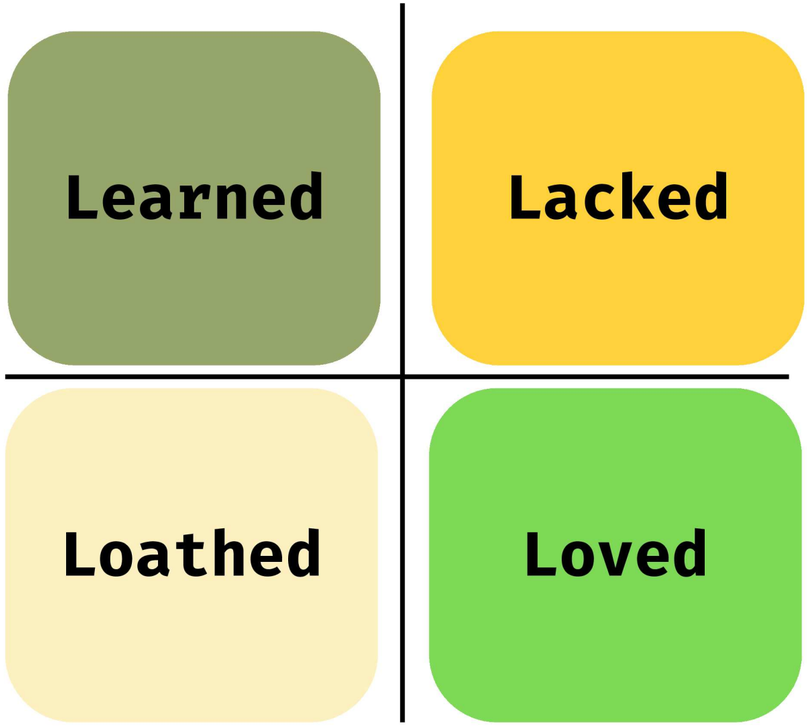
Architecture Decision Records

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

How do we currently make decisions?



4Ls Retro

Audience: Technical leadership

Questions:

How do we currently make decisions?

What is working about it?

What is not working?

More info: https://www.roundcrisis.com/2026/09/29/archicture-decision-review/

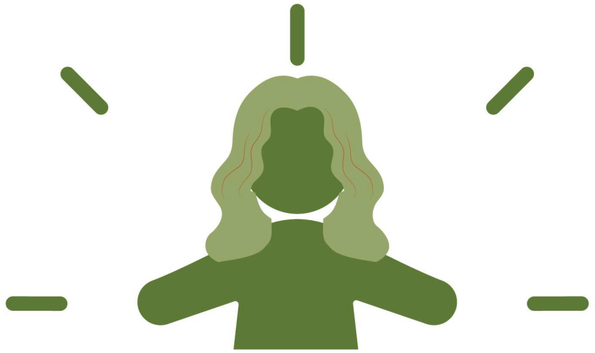
Andrea Magnorsky

www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Who makes decisions?



Part

Individual

Centralised

Whole

Team

Decentralised

Common polarities

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Polarities can be

Managed **Unmanaged**

Polarity vs problem

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Architecture Advice Process

The Rule: anyone can make an architectural decision.

The Qualifier: before making the decision, request advice from two groups

- those affected by the decision
- those that have experience in the area the decision is being taken

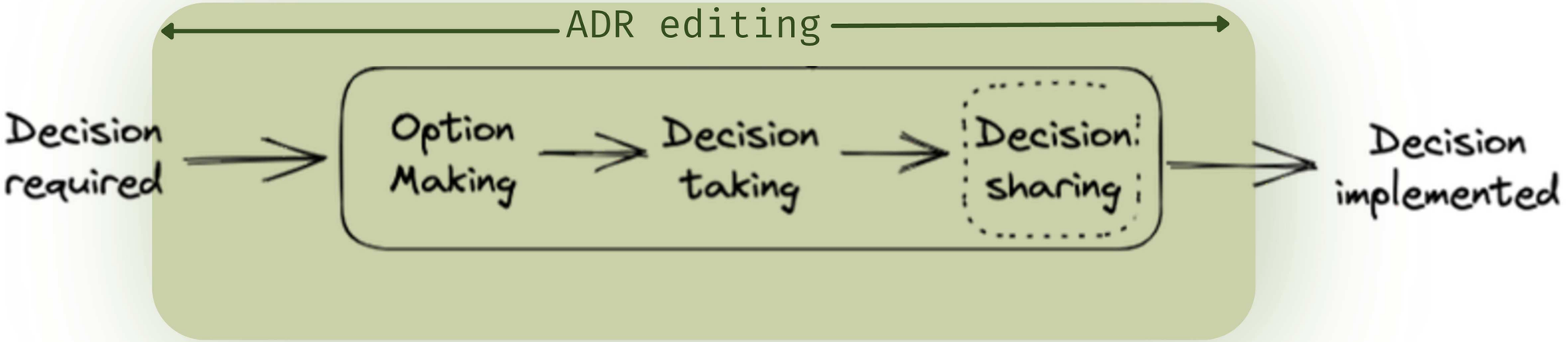
source: Facilitating Software Architecture - Andrew Harmel-Law

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Decision Making Process



source: Facilitating Software Architecture - Andrew Harmel-Law

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

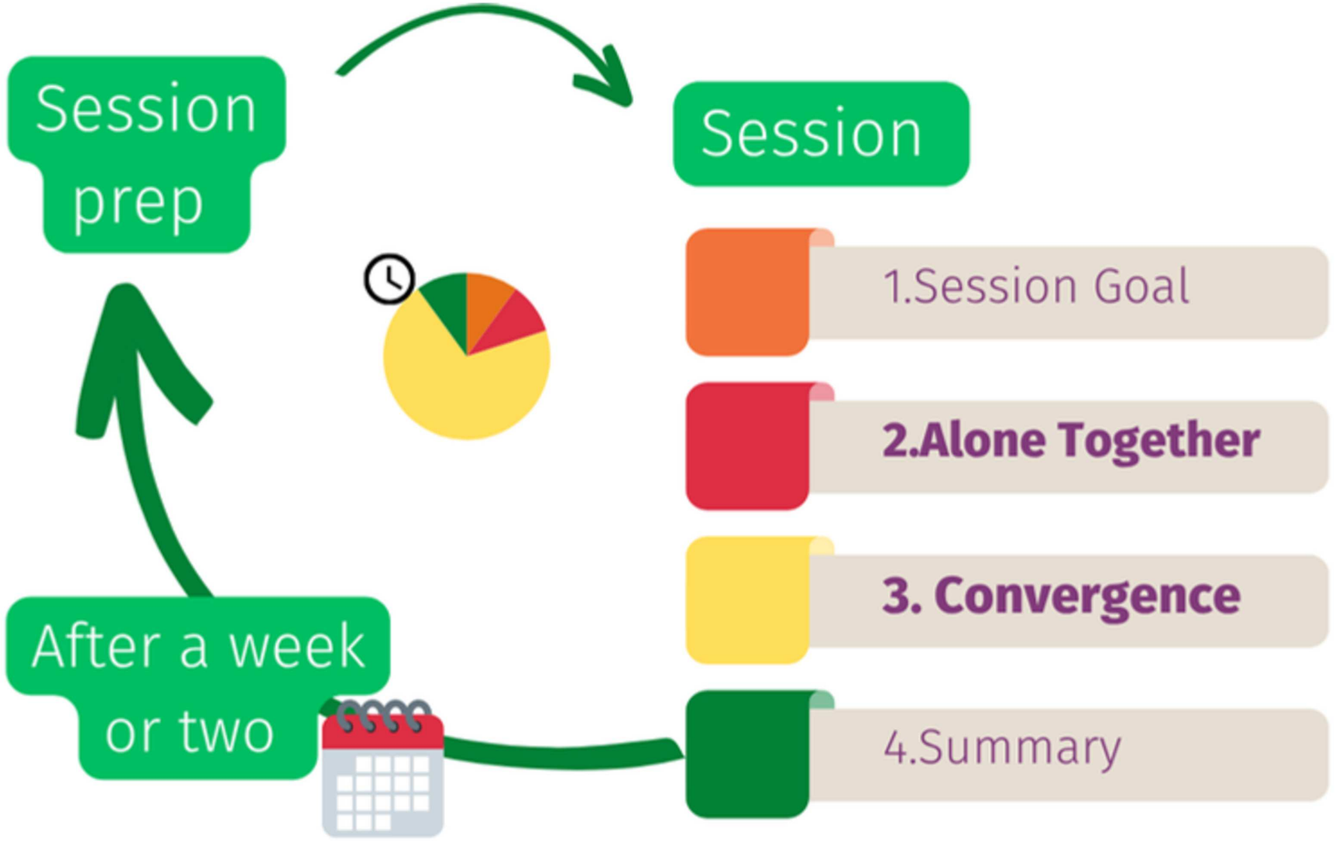
Do, Recover

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Addressing knowledge gap



Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

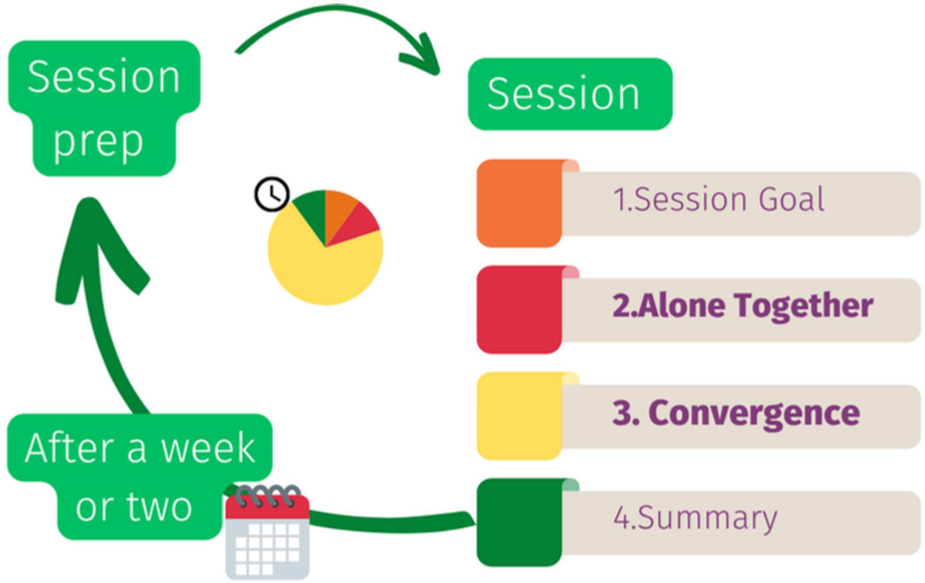
Build Community

Improve growth, learning and safety

Seeding the **practice** of architecture

Architecture Decision Records

The advice process

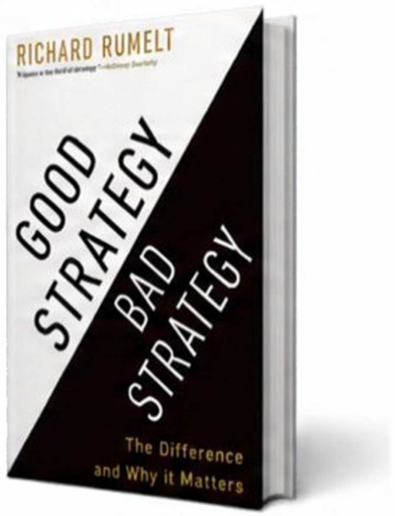


Bytesize Architecture Sessions

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Understand

Nuance, validation, feedback loops



Good Strategy, Bad Strategy. Richard Rumelt

Kernel of Strategy

Diagnosis
Defines the nature of the challenge. Simplifies the problem

Guiding policy
Overall approach chosen to overcome the issue

Coherent actions
designed to carry out the guiding policy.

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Build Community

Improve learning
and safety

Act

Do, Recover

Understand

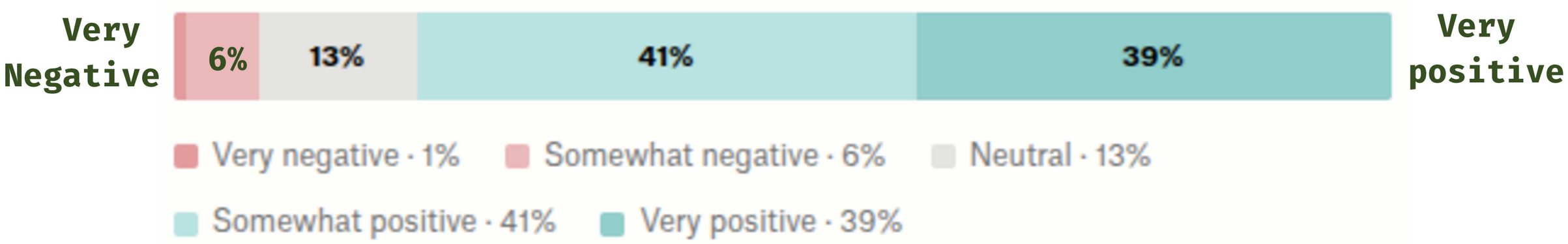
Nuance, validation,
feedback loops

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

The mess we are in

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

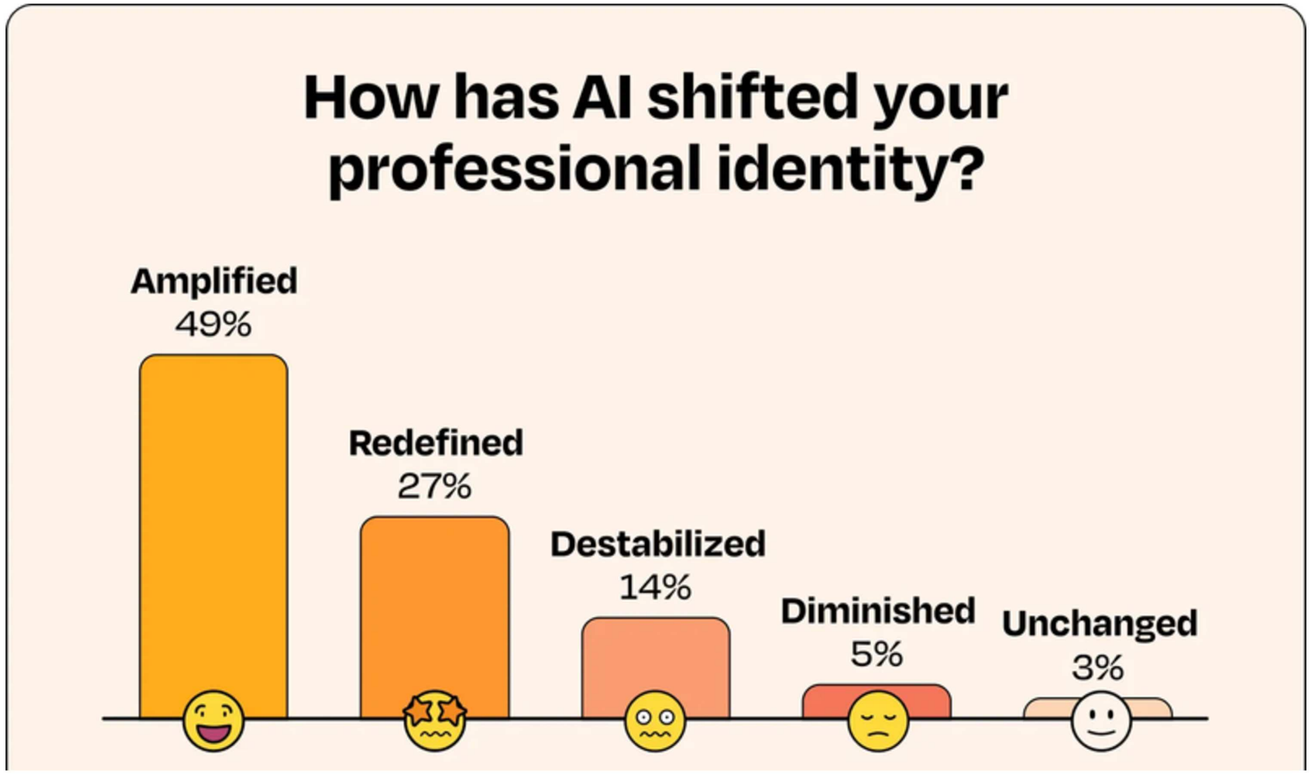
What was AI's impact on your role over the past year



https://www.lookahead.com.au/ai-engineering-whitepaper-2026
Survey of insights Australia - 272 people

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

How has AI shifted your professional identity?

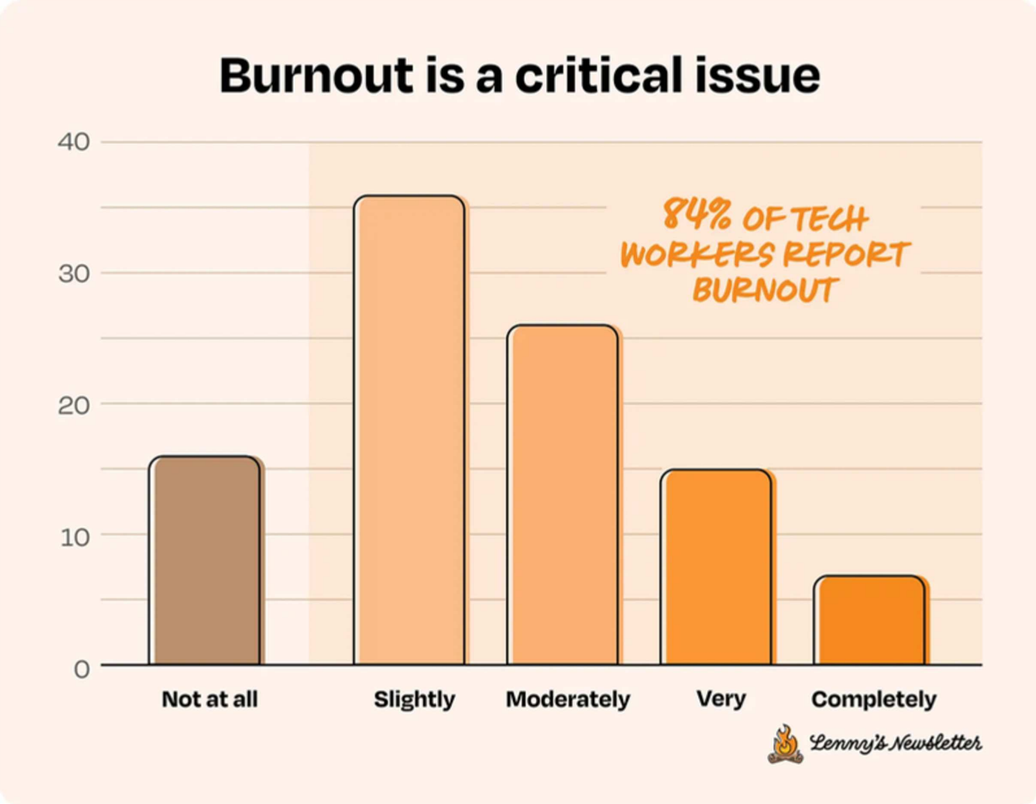


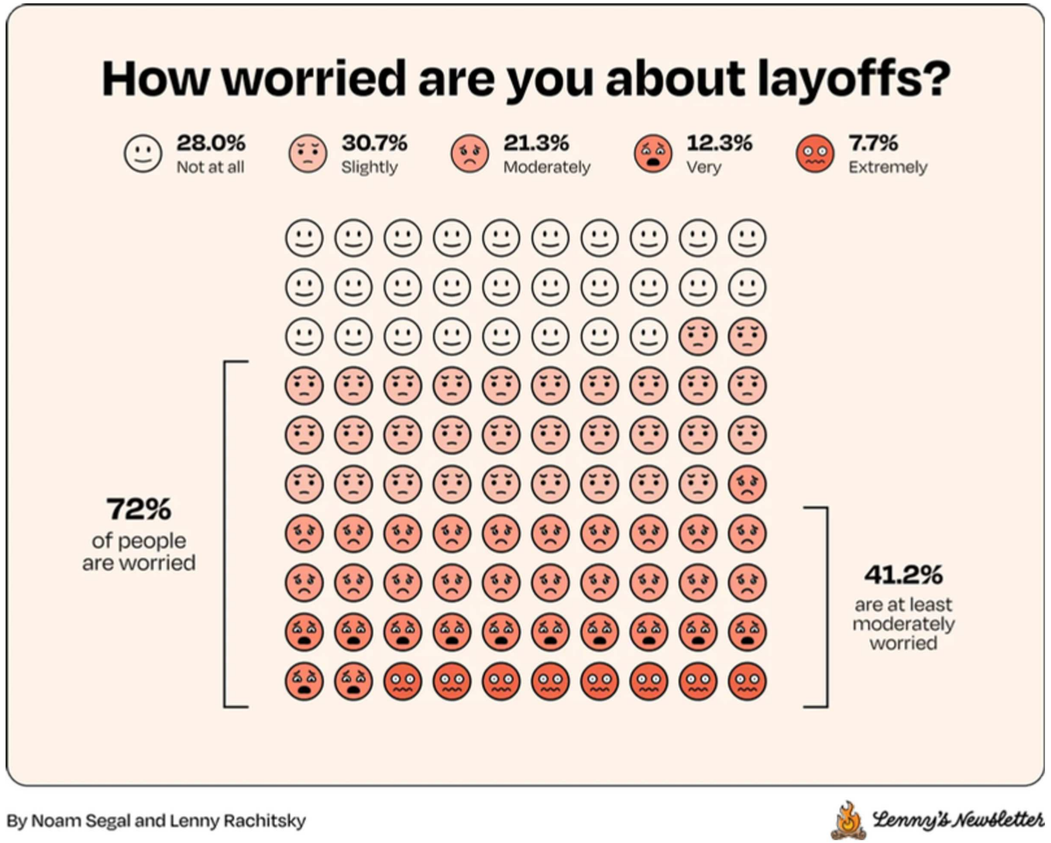
Survey of insights from over 8,200 people
Demographics: North America 50%, Europe 20%, etc.

Source: https://www.lennysnewsletter.com/p/how-tech-workers-are-feeling-in-2026

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Burnout & Layoffs

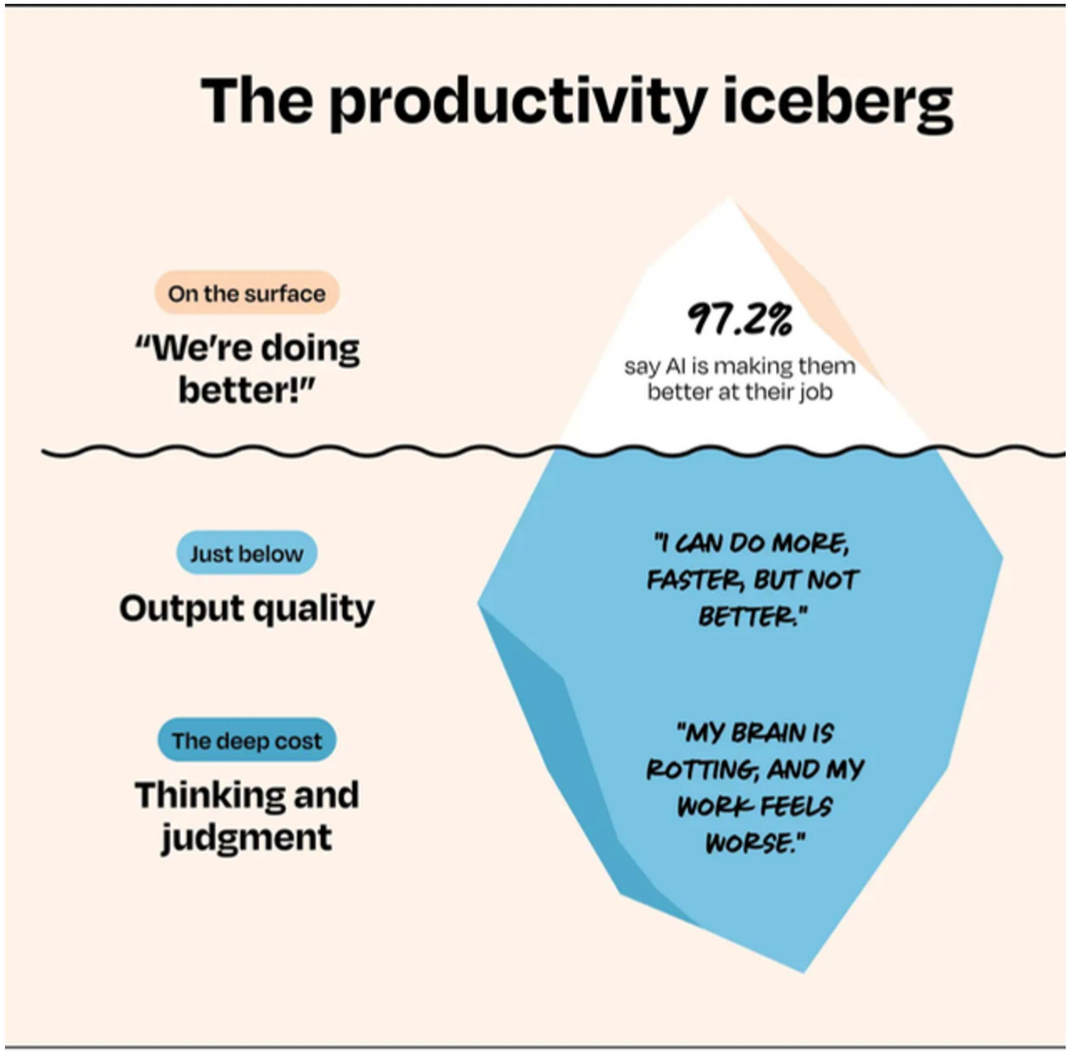




Source: https://www.lennysnewsletter.com/p/how-tech-workers-are-feeling-in-2026

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

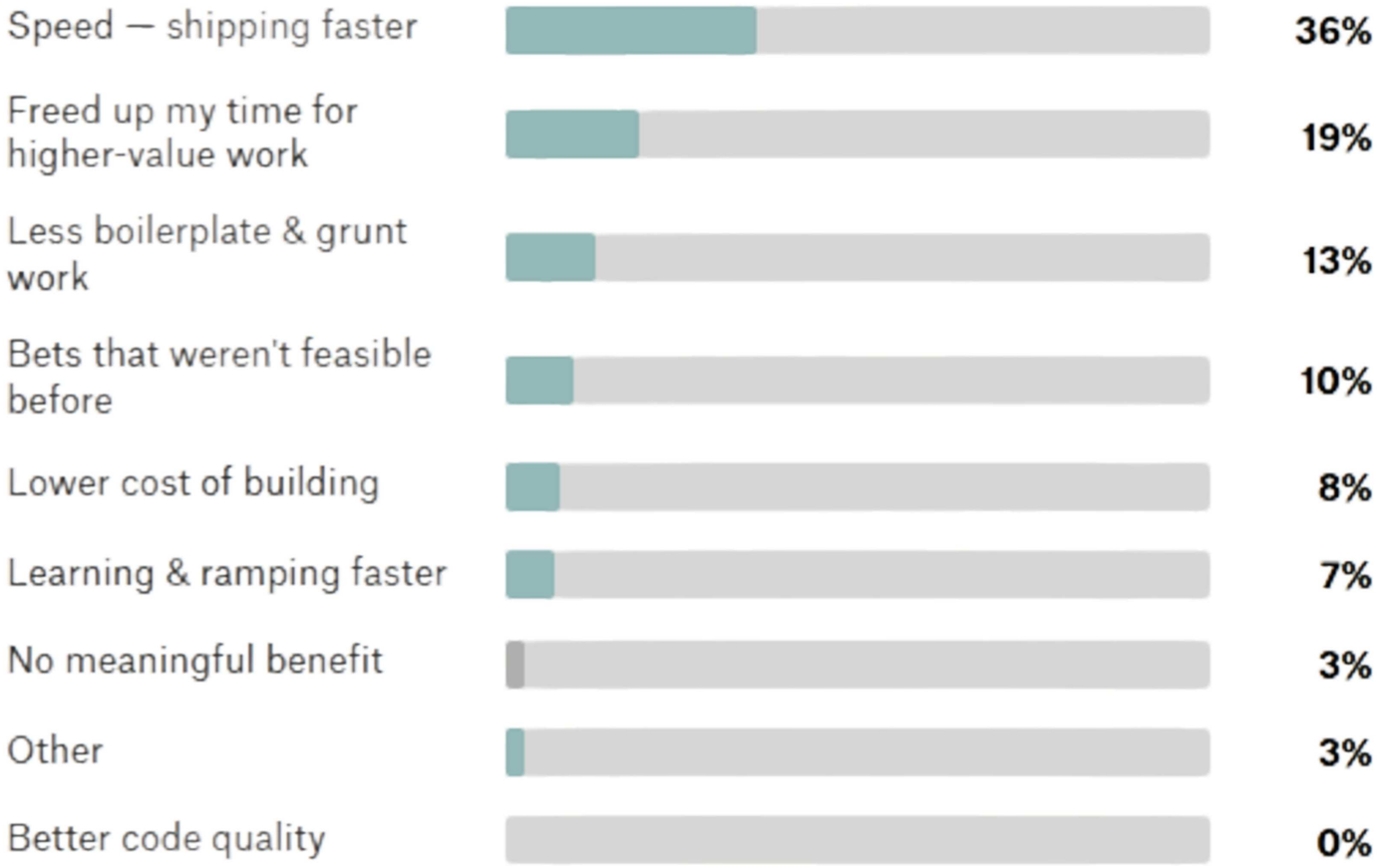
Effects on Systems



Source: https://www.lennysnewsletter.com/p/how-tech-workers-are-feeling-in-2026

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

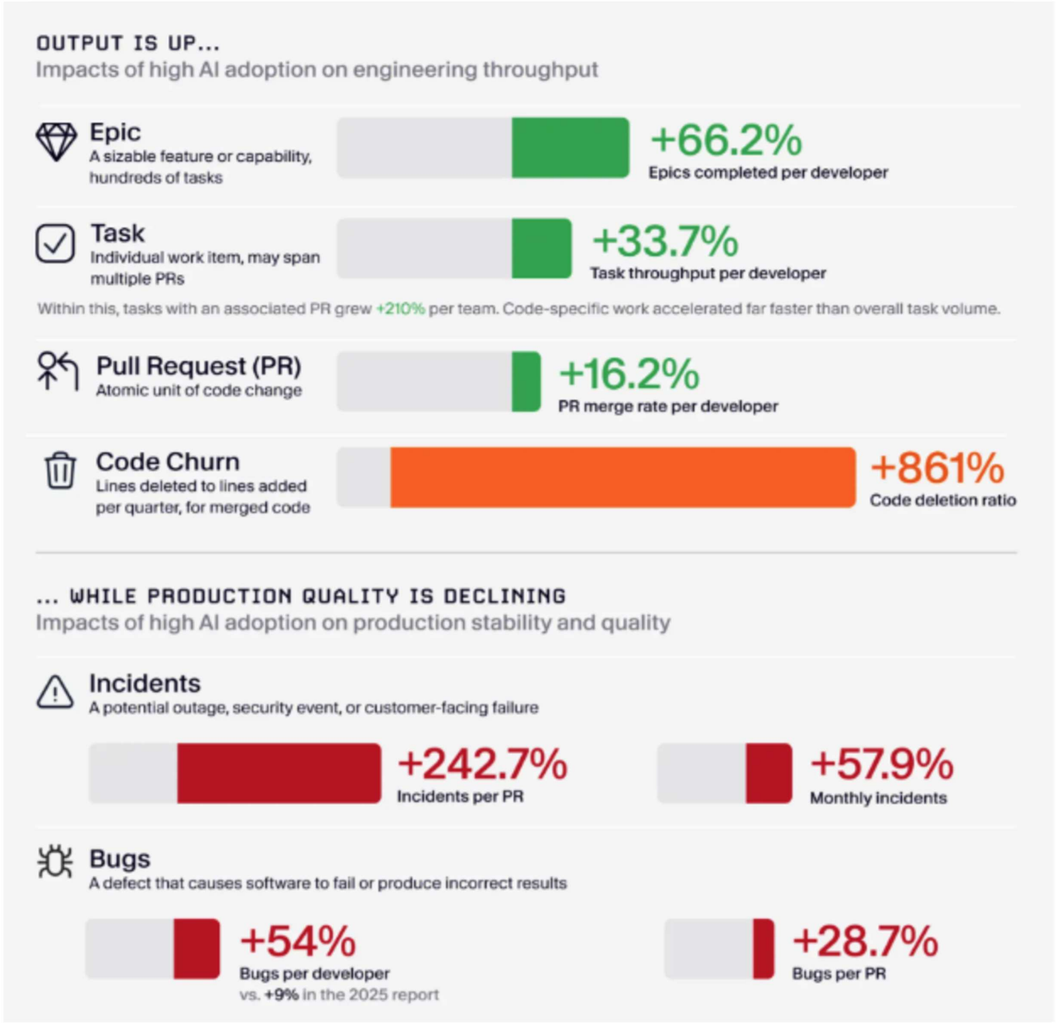
Effects on Systems



https://www.lookahead.com.au/ai-engineering-whitepaper-2026
Survey of insights Australia - 272 people

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Effects on Systems



https://www.faros.ai/blog/ai-acceleration-whiplash-takeaways
Telemetry data from 22,000 developers

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Effects on open source

Bevy. A games engine

It Breaks a Village: Bevy's 6th Birthday

10 Sep, 2026

The "AI" Policy

feel like something I can continue to use and contribute to.

Trust Is Broken and the Ground Is Uneven

Community cohesion has fallen apart under pressure of persistent trolling and conflicting community values.

The "AI" conversation has been positioned as two equal sides worthy of equal judgement. This is at odds with the context being a Game Engine as a creative tool

https://blog.fallible.net/it-breaks-a-village/#fnref-2

KDE

Adventures in Linux and KDE

Below is a brief look at recent changes in the KDE projects I work on and follow!

Get involved | Report a bug | Develop for KDE | Submit a patch | Translating posts

About Nate | Contact Nate

KDE and AI, and you, and me

12. Realizing this topic was not going away, later that day I re-opened a second draft of m LLM guidelines on invent.kde.org.
13. KDE contributors began to discuss the draft proposal.
14. Two people unknown to any KDE contributors appeared and began fighting with one another about the broader topic of the morality of AI, not the proposed guidelines.
15. One of those people doxxed the other.
16. Comments on the draft proposal were locked to only KDE developers.

https://pointieststick.com/2026/09/23/kde-and-ai-and-you-and-me/

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Understand

Nuanced questions.
During crisis might be perceived as counter intuitive

Act

Recover, Do

Build Community

Improve growth, learning and safety

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Community

Improves learning and safety

“...common ground refers to a process of communicating, testing, updating, tailoring, and repairing mutual understanding.”

Common Ground and Coordination in Joint Activity
Gary Klein, Paul J. Feltovich, Jeffrey M. Bradshaw, David D. Woods

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Community

Improves learning and safety

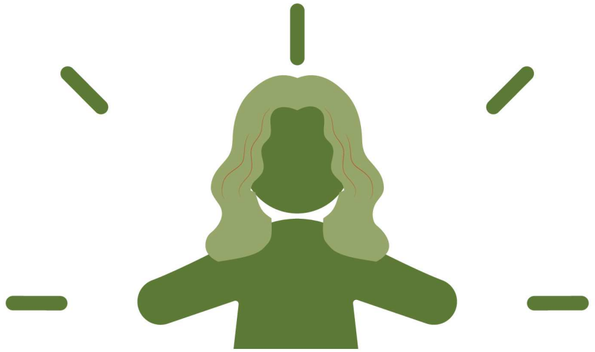
The social contract:
Listen to **understand**.
Not to respond.
Not to meet in the middle.

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Polarities



Part

Individual

Centralised

Whole

Team

Decentralised

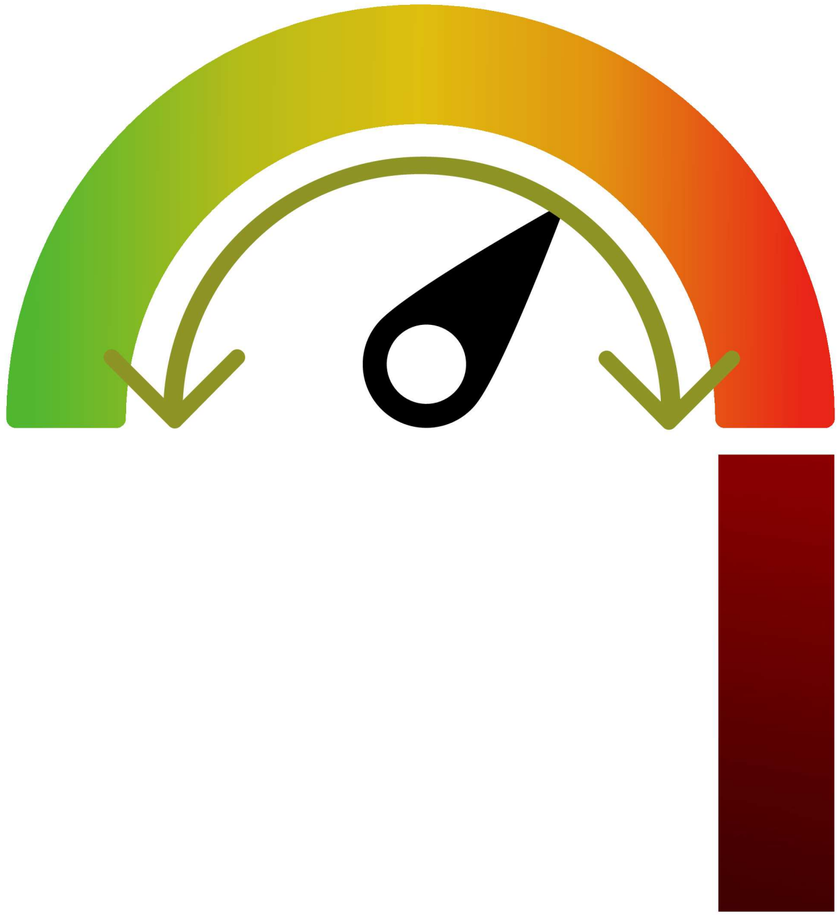
Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Act

Do, Recover

Polarities can be

Managed



Unmanaged

Weaponised

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Understand

Nuanced questions.
During crisis might be perceived as counter intuitive

Act

Recover, Do

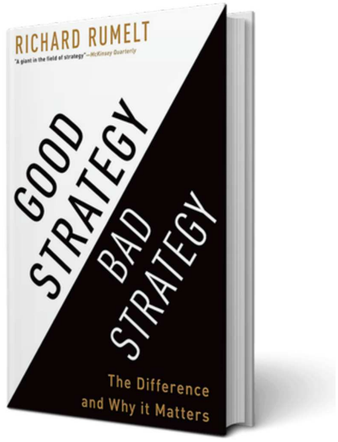
Community

Improves learning and safety

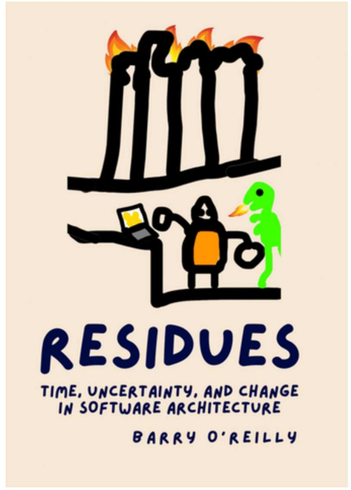
Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Related books

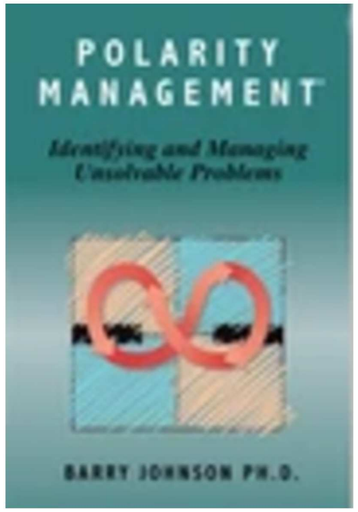


Good Strategy, Bad Strategy. Richard Rumelt

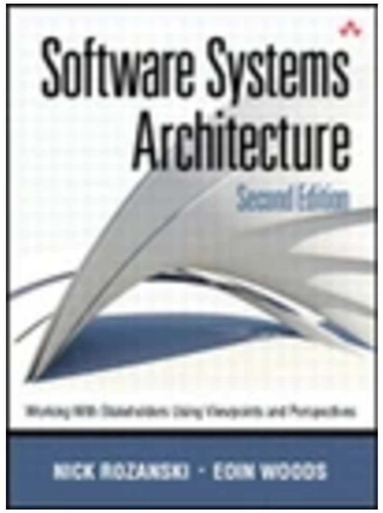


Residues. Barry O'Reilly

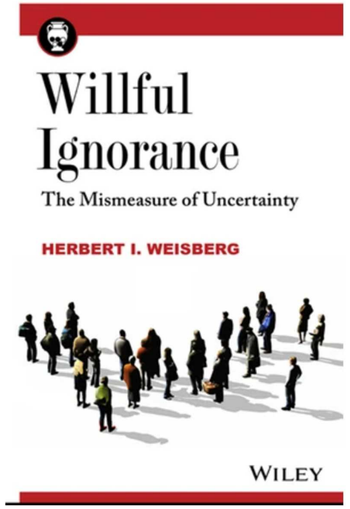
Facilitating Software Architecture
Andrew Harmel-Law



Polarity Management™:
Barry Johnson PhD



Software Systems Architecture
Nick Rozanski, Eoin Woods



Willful Ignorance: The Mismeasure of Uncertainty
Herbert Weisberg

Andrea Magnorsky
www.roundcrisis.com

Related papers

Common Ground and Coordination in Joint Activity
Gary Klein, Paul J. Feltovich, Jeffrey M. Bradshaw, David D. Woods

Sense of Community: A Definition and Theory
David W. McMillan and David M. Chavis

Thank You!

The Certainty of Uncertainty

roundcrisis.com

/in/magnorsky

@types.pl@roundcrisis

@roundcrisis.com

Resources

Thanks:Laila Bougria, Annie Vella, Chris Simon, Mike Joyce, Sonia Perkins, Donna Benjamin, Bruno Felix, Eoin Woods